

After the Floods

— میرا گھر

I.

An orchid of olive trees sway in the in wind-chime breeze,
its leaves whisper promises of seclusion from the tormenting heat
of our village. Under their protection, we shared a date palm, one you
plucked dates from your grandfather's tree. It's sickly sweet residue
coats our hands and we laugh. There's a timeless beauty of this dream,
one that nothing can take away. Not the drizzle that started when I said your name.
Not even the downpour that soon followed, the one that rampaged our lives, our country.

II.

We abandon our ancestral pastures and turn to the sea:
pleading for mercy. Her swells swallowed us with little hesitation
while the sea foam's laughter rang in our ears. In the belly of the deep,
our lungs filled with water and our breathing became hard.

Entranced in a state of tarantism, I was enthralled by the swells
of memory. With my body at its mercy, I entreat
to slip the veil off the eyes of my heart.

We came close enough to the surface.
Only to be taunted by the cruelty of relentless waves.
Oh how bitter this irony was.

III.

Outside, a chukar is singing in the dripping rain.

Rain in my heart, rain on the roof.

Drip...Drip... Drip...

The windless sky brings no dreams, only memories
of the day we sat under our olive tree.

– We'll never be those kids again.

Translations– Urdu to English:

1. میرا گھر - My Home.